

HOW TO MAKE INVISIBLE INK

The ink in this experiment is pure lemon juice. When it dries, it's invisible! To reveal your lemon-juice message or map, you need to put the paper into a hot oven. Find an adult for this part and follow the suggested temperature setting—any hotter may cause the paper to catch fire. If you are using a gas oven, make sure the paper is placed away from the flame.

WHAT YOU NEED



White paper



You will also need an oven



Time
45 minutes



Difficulty
Medium

Warning

Hot oven! Be careful, and get help from an adult



1 Cut the lemon in half and squeeze its juice into the small bowl. Once you've got as much of the juice as you can from the lemon, put its flesh and rind into a compost or recycling bin, if you have one. Then wash and dry your hands.



2 Dip the cotton swab into the lemon juice and write a message or draw something on the paper. At first, you will be able to see the lines that you draw, but then, as the lemon juice dries on the paper, it will become invisible.